

Charterhall's main thoroughfare is quiet by the time you meet with **BASIL** (*ruthless, sweaty*), owner of the aptly named and aptly spacious 'Endless Apothecary', where he proudly declares if a herb or remedy can't be found here, it doesn't exist. Basil leads you through his lengthy store before rummaging through a binder of leaflets before handing you one.

The leaflet reads: 'Big Announcement! **GOLDEN BUTTON MUSHROOMS** are now available at the Golden Harvest Grotto in Barrowcleft. Heal any wound for a small contribution. We do require that our miracle mushroom be consumed on-premises. Signed, Ravena Glenmont'

"This came to my attention only last week, and I wouldn't have believed it if I hadn't gone to Barrowcleft and seen it for myself! Get me a sample of the stuff, and make sure they can't make any more. I'll be able to charge whatever I want when I'm the only source!"

APPROACH & OBSTACLES

APPROACH: Golden Harvest has a reputation as Duskwall's best supplier of high quality edible fungus. The workers call themselves "cultivators" and are very loyal, treating Golden Harvest less like a place of work and more like a family, or a cult.

HOMESTEAD: Golden Harvest's homestead holds the grotto entrance. Wide tables out front showcase "farm-to-table" wares.

- ❖ Padlocked grotto gate only opens from the outside
- ❖ A rusting Hull checks all cultivators going in or out

GROTTO: A rickety bridge spans a crystal-clear lake. Colorful mushrooms sprout from floating gardens.

- ❖ Cultivators in togas work quietly, minimizing sound
- ❖ An unattended diving suit
- ❖ Fishing nets lift writhing masses onto the bridge

HOT SPRINGS CAVERN: Warm water bubbles up from the cavern's deepest point. Golden Buttons grow in small clusters.

- ❖ **SARHA** doesn't sleep and is always watching
- ❖ The cavern is a Spirit Well
- ❖ Harvesting Golden Buttons releases spores into the air

AREAS: mushroom lounge — director's office — worker's lodging — holding cells — Sarha's shrine
Big Tuna's underwater cave — composting pit — abandoned mine drift — cave stairs — store room

SCENES & COMPLICATIONS

"If you like, you may purchase product and consume it in the lounge. If not, I'm afraid I'll have to ask you to leave."

- ❖ Ravena orders the Hull to throw you out
- ❖ A worker demands your crew disarm
- ❖ You're prompted to recite a pass-phrase

SARHA grabs your collar and throws you down into the hot spring's water. *"You've come for the Golden Buttons! You aren't worthy!"*

- ❖ The spring water gets much, much hotter
- ❖ You sense an entity from the Spirit Well probing your mental defenses, trying to get in
- ❖ You step into a mushroom cluster, and the air is immediately thick with fungal spores

With bare feet, workers carefully navigate the bridge. It creaks under the weight, almost like it's warning you that crossing will be tricky.

- ❖ You lose your balance and fall into the water
- ❖ A worker approaches you, angrily, mistaking you for someone else. "Clumsy as always!"

You hear a voice reverberate in your head. "Don't destroy... It's my only way back in..."

- ❖ Spores coalesce into spindly figures that drag you towards the Spirit Well
- ❖ Cultivators start blockading the entrance to the cavern. "Sarha said this would happen!"
- ❖ The water in the cavern begins to rise
- ❖ You feel sluggish, like you can barely move

BREAKFAST OF CHAMPIGNONS: When consumed, a Golden Button Mushroom always repairs your body and mind, but you'll also receive one or more unexpected side effects.

A DOSE OF GOLDEN BUTTON MUSHROOMS

Optionally, roll (or have players roll) on the table below to determine one or more side effects, then have them choose either to fill their Healing Clock, or to remove a Trauma.

SIDE EFFECTS

- ☐ you feel paranoid! take +3 Stress
- ☐ you feel a deep tranquility; take -1 Stress
- ☐ you can talk to mushrooms four times*
- ☐ for the next week your skin glows green-blue
- ☐ your worst harm transfers to a random ally
- ☐ +1 to your next Insight action or resistance

PRIMARY EFFECT

Fill your Healing Clock

or

Remove a Trauma

* Player creates a resource clock  with four segments. Each time the resource is used, they increment the clock.

CAST OF CHARACTERS

RAVENA GLENMONT. Long-time elected director of Golden Harvest. She doesn't eat the mushrooms, but is respected for her mutually beneficial, detailed contracts.

(Patient, Cunning)

Wants to lead a successful business and make fruitful deals with other farmers

Doesn't want Golden Harvest to suffer financially or from bad publicity

SARHA. Self-proclaimed spiritual leader of Golden Harvest's cultivators. She has some permanent effects from regular Golden Button use, which once healed bites she received from cave-fishing.

(Somber, Spiritual)

Wants to bring new members into the cult and to share the cult's meditation rituals

Doesn't want the Hot Springs to be disrespected

BIG TUNA. A huge, ancient cave fish living in the grotto's lake. He's become aggressive with age, and although his eyesight isn't what it used to be, there have been some close calls among the cultivators.

(Hungry, Armored, Slippery)

Wants to drag live prey into his underwater cave

Doesn't want his territory (the lake) to be disturbed or to hear loud noises

CLOCKS & CONSEQUENCES

CAVE FISH DESTROY THE BRIDGE (🕒 6)

Loud noises and other disturbances create turmoil in the grotto lake, pushing the cave fish into an angry frenzy.

THE CULT IS ALERTED (🕒 4)

The cultivators are numerous and they're not going to let you leave without a fight. You should have been more careful.

Basil is beaming, and looks *very* pleased with your work. His voice quavers with excitement as he hands over a hefty bag of coin.

"I'm very pleased with your work! I heard about what happened at Golden Harvest. Did you get the mushrooms? I'm going to be the wealthiest man in Charterhall — no, in Duskwall! — as soon as I start cultivating these little money-makers!"

He holds out a hand, expectantly.